

WORKING WITH 1 - 5 - 10

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #141

An wonderful melodic shape (and a fantastic harmonic voicing) is the root, the fifth, and the third, in that order from the bass up. It is just a triad (1-3-5), but when we reorder those notes, we get something a bit more interesting. We just move the 3rd up an octave to become a 10th. In C, this shape is C (the root), G (the 5th) and up to E (a 10th).

J. S. Bach famously used this sound as the opening melody in his Cello Suite #1. It is an interesting sound because it gets us playing intervals other than our typical 2nds and 3rds (scales and triads). This shape is built of 5ths and 6ths, lovely and "less played" intervals.

Chords of "Stella By Starlight," using 1 - 5 - 10

The image displays the first five staves of the musical score for "Stella By Starlight" in 4/4 time. Each staff features a melodic line in treble clef and a series of chords written above the staff. The chords are: Eø7, A7(b9), Cm7, F7, Fm7, Bb7, Ebmaj7, Ab7, Bbmaj7, Eø7, A7(b9), Dm7, Bbm7, Eb7, Fmaj7, Eø7, Aø7, D7(b9), G7(b9), Cm7, and etc... The melodic line consists of eighth and quarter notes, often beamed together, illustrating the 1-5-10 shape across various keys.